

On the other hand, while co-writing with AI in more creative settings also produces content, this content is often delivered one way to a larger audience and does not involve a bi-directional message exchange between writers and readers. Furthermore, our study reveals that the practice of writing extends far beyond crafting the content, and conveying messages to the audience is simply the final step. Given these distinctions, we expect insights of the present work to apply to comprehending AI's role in facilitating (1) uni-directional presentation of content to a group of individuals and (2) creative practices that nurture the creators and enrich their work, as these practices can extend beyond the content production phase.

5.5 Limitations and Future Work

Despite our best efforts and mixed-methods approach to studying this topic, we acknowledge several limitations of the present work as well as the fast-changing landscape and public sentiment in the AI space. To begin with, data collection for the present work took place from June to October of 2023. This is unique timing as the public has been somewhat exposed to the popular trend of generative AI and its use for text production but has not yet moved to complete acceptance and adoption of the new technology. During this period, new applications of AI writing assistance were also being regularly deployed. For example, Jasper AI rolled out new features targeting at AI-assisted writing for marketing and branding purposes⁵ soon after we conducted Part 1 of the study. Therefore, we also expect writers', readers', and the general public's opinions toward this topic to shift over time.

Moreover, we expect that our writers' and readers' responses may be affected by the extensive media coverage surrounding generative AI in 2023. We encourage future work to examine trends across time, capturing and following how writers' and readers' responses change through longitudinal research. In particular, an interesting topic to explore is whether any of these attitudinal or behavioral changes occur due to advances in new AI applications or due to changes in public regulations, media depictions, or other external factors.

We acknowledge some findings from the present work that might be related to the unique backgrounds and experiences of our participants. As experienced experts, many of our writer participants have developed their own structures and workflows for professional writing. We noticed their feedback on co-writing with AI might focus more on its potential to facilitate the ideation of content, while they mentioned less about AI's assistance with the structure and composition of writing. Our reader participants recruited from Reddit might also possess unique characteristics. Recent surveys showed Reddit users possessed unique social norms, personalities, and demographic breakdowns [12, 19]. Specifically, Gjurković et al. found Reddit users were rated with particularly high Openness scores in the Big5 personality scales [19]. While this can be relevant to our reader participants' accepting attitudes toward writers' use of AI tools for writing, we encourage future work to explore further this relationship and/or conduct studies of relevant topics across multiple platforms.

On the other hand, future work should consider conducting larger-scale studies, surveying both expert and non-expert writers as well as avid and regular audiences. This allows researchers to better account for the influences of participants' positionalities on their views toward authenticity. Moreover, our study only examined a limited scope of writer-reader relationships. Specifically, the readers passively and leisurely consumed the writing we provided, with a greater focus on the "reading experience" than on seeking out particular writers. Our results may not generalize to readers who actively seek out work from or take a personal interest in a particular writer.

⁵Jasper AI's news press on their launch of new features of AI marketing toolkit: <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/jasper-partners-with-google-workspace-webflow-make-and-zapier-to-bring-on-brand-ai-content-across-the-marketing-stack-301911844.html>

Among the three versions of work produced by our writer participants, the pieces composed without any AI assistance were done without any time constraints. All writer participants acknowledged that writing under time pressure was a common part of their day-to-day job and that the speed they wrote during the study sessions was at their usual pace. Still, we encourage future work to investigate whether time constraints might influence writers' tendencies to and the ways they engage with AI-writing assistance tools.

Finally, though we supplement writers' perspectives with those of readers, our focus remains on writing as creative work and has not captured views from other stakeholders (e.g., writers' clients) who focus on the potential market value of writing. We have not yet thoroughly explored how the changing writer economy, to which participants have also hinted as possible influences, might affect writers' decisions and work. Therefore, we encourage future work to further explore the impact of human-AI co-creation on the monetization of creative work.

6 CONCLUSION

The present work examines writers' and readers' perceptions toward co-writing with AI assistance and its potential impact on the authenticity of writing. To address these questions, we conducted a two-part research, including a series of in-depth interviews with professional writers and an online study with avid readers. Despite their hesitation to acknowledge AI co-writing as authentic work at the beginning of the study, nearly all writers recognized authenticity in AI co-writing. Specifically, they suggested co-writing with personalized AI based on their own writing samples could more effectively support writers in preserving their authentic voices and tones in writing. From the readers' perspectives, while many of them could tell the difference between a writer's independent work and AI-assisted work, they appreciated writers experimenting with new technologies to perform their writing jobs and expressed interest in reading content co-written with AI. Together, the present work makes three contributions: (1) We synthesize some writer-centered conceptions of authenticity in the age of human-AI collaboration. (2) We provide insights into how to support writers in preserving their authenticity in writing. (3) We reflect on readers' attitudes toward reading AI-co-writing work. Together, these insights offer practical implications for designing future AI co-writing tools.

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